

Fix Your WordPress Social Preview

Why this matters

You know that card that shows up when someone shares a link on LinkedIn or X? That is your social preview. And if you have not set it up on your WordPress site, the platform just guesses what to show. Sometimes it picks a random image, sometimes it shows nothing at all.

It is a small thing that makes a real difference. A good preview can be the reason someone clicks your link instead of scrolling past it. Let's get yours sorted.

Before you start

You will need admin access to your WordPress site and a preview image at 1200 x 630px. We will use the free Yoast SEO plugin, no code needed.

Step 1 - Install Yoast SEO

If you already have Yoast SEO installed, skip ahead to Step 2. If not, here is how to get it set up in about a minute.

- 1 Log into your WordPress dashboard
- 2 Go to Plugins, then Add New
- 3 Search for Yoast SEO
- 4 Click Install Now, then Activate

Using a different SEO plugin?

RankMath and All in One SEO work the same way. The fields are identical, just in slightly different places. Search for 'social' inside your plugin's settings and you will find them.

Step 2 - Set your default social image

This is your fallback. Any page that does not have its own image set will use this one, so it is worth spending a minute on it before anything else.

- 1 In your WordPress dashboard, go to Yoast SEO, then Settings
- 2 Click the Social tab
- 3 Under Default image, upload your 1200 x 630px image
- 4 Click Save Changes

Step 3 - Set previews for your important pages

Your homepage, landing pages, and top blog posts should each have a preview that reflects exactly what is on that page. The default image works as a backup, but a specific one performs much better.

- 1 Open the page or post you want to update
- 2 Scroll down to the Yoast SEO panel below the editor
- 3 Click the Social tab (the share icon)
- 4 Fill in the Facebook title, description, and image
- 5 Do the same in the Twitter tab if you want a different version there
- 6 Click Update or Publish

Quick tip

You do not have to fill in both the Facebook and Twitter tabs. If you leave Twitter blank, platforms will fall back to your Facebook (og:) values automatically.

Step 4 - Get your image size right

This is the most common reason previews look off. Design to 1200 x 630px and you will be covered across every platform.

Platform	Recommended size
X (Twitter)	1200 x 630px

LinkedIn	1200 x 627px
Facebook	1200 x 630px
Safe zone	Keep text and logos within the centre 1000 x 530px

Canva has a pre-sized template called Facebook link image that works perfectly. Figma is great too. Just export at 1200 x 630px and you are good.

What Yoast quietly adds to your page

When you fill in those fields, Yoast drops this into your page's head tag automatically. You never need to touch it yourself, but it is good to know it is there.

```
<!-- Open Graph (Facebook, LinkedIn) -->

<meta property="og:title" content="Your page title" />

<meta property="og:description" content="Your description" />

<meta property="og:image" content="https://yoursite.com/image.jpg" />

<meta property="og:url" content="https://yoursite.com/page" />

<!-- Twitter Card -->

<meta name="twitter:card" content="summary_large_image" />

<meta name="twitter:title" content="Your page title" />

<meta name="twitter:description" content="Your description" />

<meta name="twitter:image" content="https://yoursite.com/image.jpg" />
```

Check how it actually looks

Once you have saved your changes, head over to eloho.dev/freebies/social-preview and paste your URL in. You will see exactly what your link looks like across X, LinkedIn, and Facebook, and get a clear breakdown of anything that still needs attention.

If something still looks stale after updating, platforms hold on to cached previews for a while. You can force each one to refresh:

- Facebook: Sharing Debugger at developers.facebook.com/tools/debug, click Scrape Again
 - LinkedIn: Post Inspector at linkedin.com/post-inspector, click Inspect
 - X (Twitter): Card Validator at cards-dev.twitter.com/validator
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Before you call it done

- Yoast SEO installed and active
- Default social image set in Yoast, then Settings, then Social
- Homepage has its own og:title, description, and image
- Top blog posts and landing pages have their own social images
- All images are 1200 x 630px
- Checked with eloho.dev/freebies/social-preview

Done? Run your other pages through too.

It is easy to fix the homepage and forget the rest. Paste any URL into eloho.dev/freebies/social-preview and you will see exactly what shows up when that page gets shared.
